> Officials would have fastened on to these new subcommittees as a way of getting all the secondary issues raised up and also as a way of getting into the act of top decisionmaking. [Soon]…there would have been two or three levels of committees. They would have been in existence long enough so that people had vested rights…. You would have had an Operations Coordinating Board structure magnified and growing like Topsy. Then suppose the whole thing had evolved successfully. The President would…be faced with having to destroy the…[structure]…in order to get back some flexibility.*

As this suggests, the same forces that shape presidential needs also shape the needs of bureaucrats, but in different ways. Well before the Soviets achieved an ICBM capability, the place of change in our own weaponry, combined with our wide-ranging economic and political endeavors overseas, was mixing up the jurisdictions of all agencies with roles to play, or claim, in national security: mingling operations along programmatic lines, cutting across vertical lines of authority, breaching the neat boxes on organizational charts. Defense, State, CIA, AID, Treasury, together with the President's Executive Office staffs, came to form a single complex—a national security complex, tied together by an intricate network of program and staff interrelationships in Washington and in the field. The Atomic Energy Commission, the Arms Control and Disarmament Agency, and USIA are also in the complex; others lurk nearby, tied in to a degree, as, for example, Commerce.

As early as the National Security Act of 1947, we formally acknowledged the close ties of foreign, military, economic policy; these ties had been rendered very plain by World War II experience. But in pre-Korean War years when the Marshall Plan was on its own, when CIA was new, when military aid programs were hardly heard of, while atom bombs were ours alone, and military budgets stood at under $15 billion, a Secretary of Defense could forbid contacts between Pentagon and State at any level lower than his own, and, within limits, could enforce his ban. That happened no longer ago than 1949. In bureaucratic terms it is as remote as the Stone Age.

While operations now have been entangled inextricably, our formal organizations and their statutory powers and the jurisdictions of Congressional committees remain much as ever: distinct, disparate, dispersed. Our personnel systems are equally dispersed. In the national security complex alone, we have at least seven separate professional